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Caster et al.

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(54) **BLUEBERRY PLANT NAMED**
‘DRISBLUETEN’

(50) Latin Name: *Vaccinium corymbosum* L.
Varietal Denomination: **DrisBlueTen**

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(*) Notice: Subject to any disclaimer, the term of this
patent is extended or adjusted under 35
U.S.C. 154(b) by 175 days.

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A01H 5/08 (2006.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**
USPC **Plt./157**

(58) **Field of Classification Search**
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See application file for complete search history.

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new and distinct variety of blueberry plant named ‘Dris-
BlueTen’ particularly distinguished by having an early har-
vest season, strong vigor and large, firm berries, is disclosed.

2 Drawing Sheets

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Genus and species: *Vaccinium corymbosum* L.
Variety denomination: ‘DrisBlueTen’.

BACKGROUND OF THE NEW PLANT

The invention relates to a new and distinct blueberry vari-
ety designated ‘DrisBlueTen’ and botanically known as *Vac-*
cinium corymbosum L. This new blueberry variety was dis-
covered in Santa Cruz County, Calif. in September 2003 and
originated from a cross between the female parent blueberry
plant ‘Nui’ (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 6,699) and the proprietary
male parent blueberry plant ‘MS122’ (unpatented). The origi-
nal seedling of the new variety was first asexually propagated
via softwood cuttings at a nursery in Monterey County, Calif.
in 2002. ‘DrisBlueTen’ was subsequently asexually propa-
gated via softwood cuttings and underwent further testing at
a nursery in Santa Cruz County, Calif. for eight years (2005-
2012). The present invention has been found to be stable and
reproduce true to type through successive asexual propaga-
tions via softwood cuttings.

Plant Breeder’s Rights for this variety have not been
applied for. ‘DrisBlueTen’ has not been made publicly avail-
able or sold more than one year prior to the filing date of this
application.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

The following are the most outstanding and distinguishing
characteristics of this new cultivar when grown under normal
horticultural practices in Santa Cruz County, Calif.

1. Early harvest season;
2. Strong vigor; and
3. Large, firm berries.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

This new blueberry plant is illustrated by the accompany-
ing photographs which show fruit of the plant as well as the

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flowers and leaves. The colors shown are as true as can be
reasonably obtained by conventional photographic proce-
dures. The photographs are of plants that are four years old.

FIG. 1 shows a close-up of the mature flowers.

FIG. 2 shows a close-up of the leaves.

FIG. 3 shows a close-up of the whole fruit and a cross-
section of the fruit.

DESCRIPTION OF THE NEW CULTIVAR

The following detailed description sets forth the distinctive
characteristics of ‘DrisBlueTen’. The data which define these
characteristics is based on observations taken in Santa Cruz
County, Calif. from 2005-2012. This description is in accor-
dance with UPOV terminology. Color designations, color
descriptions, and other phenotypical descriptions may devi-
ate from the stated values and descriptions depending upon
variation in environmental, seasonal, climatic and cultural
conditions. ‘DrisBlueTen’ has not been observed under all
possible environmental conditions. The botanical description
of ‘DrisBlueTen’ was taken from 4 year-old plants. Color
references are primarily to The R.H.S. Colour Chart of The
Royal Horticultural Society of London (R.H.S.) (2007 edi-
tion). Descriptive terminology follows the *Plant Identifica-*
tion Terminology, An Illustrated Glossary, 2nd edition by
James G. Harris and Melinda Woolf Harris, unless where
otherwise defined.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

Classification:

Family.—Ericaceae.

Botanical.—*Vaccinium corymbosum* L.

Common name.—Blueberry.

Variety name.—‘DrisBlueTen’.

Parentage:

Female parent.—The blueberry plant ‘Nui’ (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 6,699).

Male parent.—The proprietary blueberry plant ‘MS122’ (unpatented).

Plant:

Size.—Small.

Height.—83.8 cm.

Width.—82.0 cm.

Length/width ratio.—1.0.

Plant vigor.—Strong.

Growth habit.—Semi-erect to spreading.

Productivity.—Medium.

Cold hardiness.—Medium; USDA Plant Hardiness Zone 6.

Chilling requirement.—High.

Propagation.—Soft wood cuttings.

Time of vegetative bud burst.—Medium.

Fruiting type.—Only on one-year-old shoots.

Cane renewal.—Medium.

Internode length (upper half on one-year old shoot).—24.8 mm.

One-year old canes (young canes).—Length: 87.0 cm. Diameter at the base: 8.0 mm. Diameter at the tip: 7.0 mm. Texture: Smooth. Color (One-year old shoot, branch and canes): RHS 152C (Medium yellow-green).

Five-year old canes (mature canes).—Length: 82.0 cm. Diameter at the base: 18.5 mm. Diameter at the tip: 3.2 mm. Texture: Rough. Color: RHS 197B (Medium greyed-green).

Leaves:

Length.—Medium; 5.55 cm.

Width.—Medium; 3.65 cm.

Length/width ratio.—1.5; Longer than broad.

Shape.—Elliptic.

Apex.—Cuspidate.

Base.—Obtuse.

Margin.—Entire.

Glossiness.—Medium.

Pubescence.—Glabrous (Absent).

Sheath.—Absent.

Arrangement.—Alternate.

Venation.—Reticulate.

Color.—Upper surface: Dark; RHS 137A (Dark green). Lower surface: Medium; RHS 146A (Medium yellow-green).

Internode length (one-year old shoot, upper half).—Short; 17.88 mm.

Petiole:

Length.—1.8 mm.

Diameter.—1.28 mm.

Color.—RHS 145B (Light yellow-green).

Flowers:

Length (excluding peduncle).—Very long; 10.50 mm.

Diameter.—6.93 mm.

Length/width ratio.—1.5.

Color.—RHS 155D (White).

Flower bud.—Length: 4.0 mm. Width: 3.0 mm. Number of flowers per bud or peduncle: 8. Color on immature buds: Dark; RHS 183A (Greyed-purple). Color on mature buds: Medium; RHS 64B (Red-purple).

Petal width.—4.71 mm.

Fragrance.—Medium.

Time of beginning flowering on one-year shoot.—Early.

Pedice.—Length: 7.47 mm. Diameter: 0.86 mm. Color: RHS N144D (Medium yellow-green).

Corolla.—Height of corolla tube: 10.5 mm. Diameter of corolla tube: 6.93 mm. Aperture diameter: 4.21 mm. Shape: Urceolate (Urn-shaped). Size of corolla tube: Large. Anthocyanin coloration of corolla tube: Very weak or absent; RHS 155D (White). Ridges on tube: Present.

Peduncle.—Length: 18.01 mm. Surface texture: Smooth. Color: RHS N144D (Medium yellow-green).

Reproductive organs:

Style length (including stigma).—Medium to long; 8.64 mm.

Style color.—RHS N144C (Medium yellow-green).

Ovary color.—RHS 133C (Medium green).

Pollination requirement.—Intermediate.

Pollen amount.—Medium.

Pollen color.—RHS 8D (Light yellow).

Anther color.—RHS 26A (Medium orange).

Fruit:

Size.—Large.

Length.—11.62 mm.

Width.—16.35 mm.

Length/width ratio.—0.7.

Fruit pedicel diameter.—1.14 mm.

Weight.—3.0 g.

Number of berries per cluster.—7.20.

Cluster density.—Medium.

Shape in longitudinal sections.—Oblate.

Intensity of green color (immature fruit with bloom).—Medium; RHS 191B (Medium greyed-green).

Color of skin (immature fruit without bloom).—RHS N79A (Dark purple).

Color of skin (mature fruit without bloom).—RHS 103A (Dark blue).

Color of skin (mature fruit with bloom).—RHS 104D (Light blue).

Intensity of bloom (mature fruit).—Strong.

Attitude of sepals.—Incurving.

Calyx.—Diameter of basin: Medium; 5.56 mm. Depth of basin: Medium; 2.79 mm. Diameter/depth ratio: 2.0.

Flesh color.—RHS 145D (Light yellow-green).

Firmness.—Medium to firm.

Sweetness.—Medium to high.

Acidity.—Low to medium.

Time of beginning of fruit ripening (one-year old shoots).—Early.

Harvest season.—Early.

Harvest interval.—Late-May to early August.

Seeds:

Length.—1.58 mm.

Width.—0.77 mm.

Length/width ratio.—2.1.

Abundance.—Medium.

Color.—RHS N167A (Medium greyed-orange).

Resistance to pests and diseases: Data not available.

COMPARISON WITH PARENTAL AND COMMERCIAL VARIETIES

‘DrisBlueTen’ differs from the female parent ‘Nui’ (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 6,699) in that ‘DrisBlueTen’ ripens earlier than ‘Nui’ and has fruit that is smaller size than ‘Nui’.

‘DrisBlueTen’ differs from the commercial variety ‘Elliott’ (unpatented) in that ‘DrisBlueTen’ has large berries with medium to high sweetness, whereas ‘Elliott’ has medium to large sized berries that are quite tart unless picked fully ripe. ‘DrisBlueTen’ differs from the commercial variety ‘Blue-
crop’ (unpatented), in that ‘DrisBlueTen’ has a semi-erect to spreading growth habit, whereas ‘Bluecrop’ has an upright

growth habit. Additionally, ‘DrisBlueTen’ has an early harvest season, whereas ‘Bluecrop’ has a mid-season harvest.

We claim:

1. A new and distinct variety of blueberry plant named ‘DrisBlueTen’ as shown and described herein.

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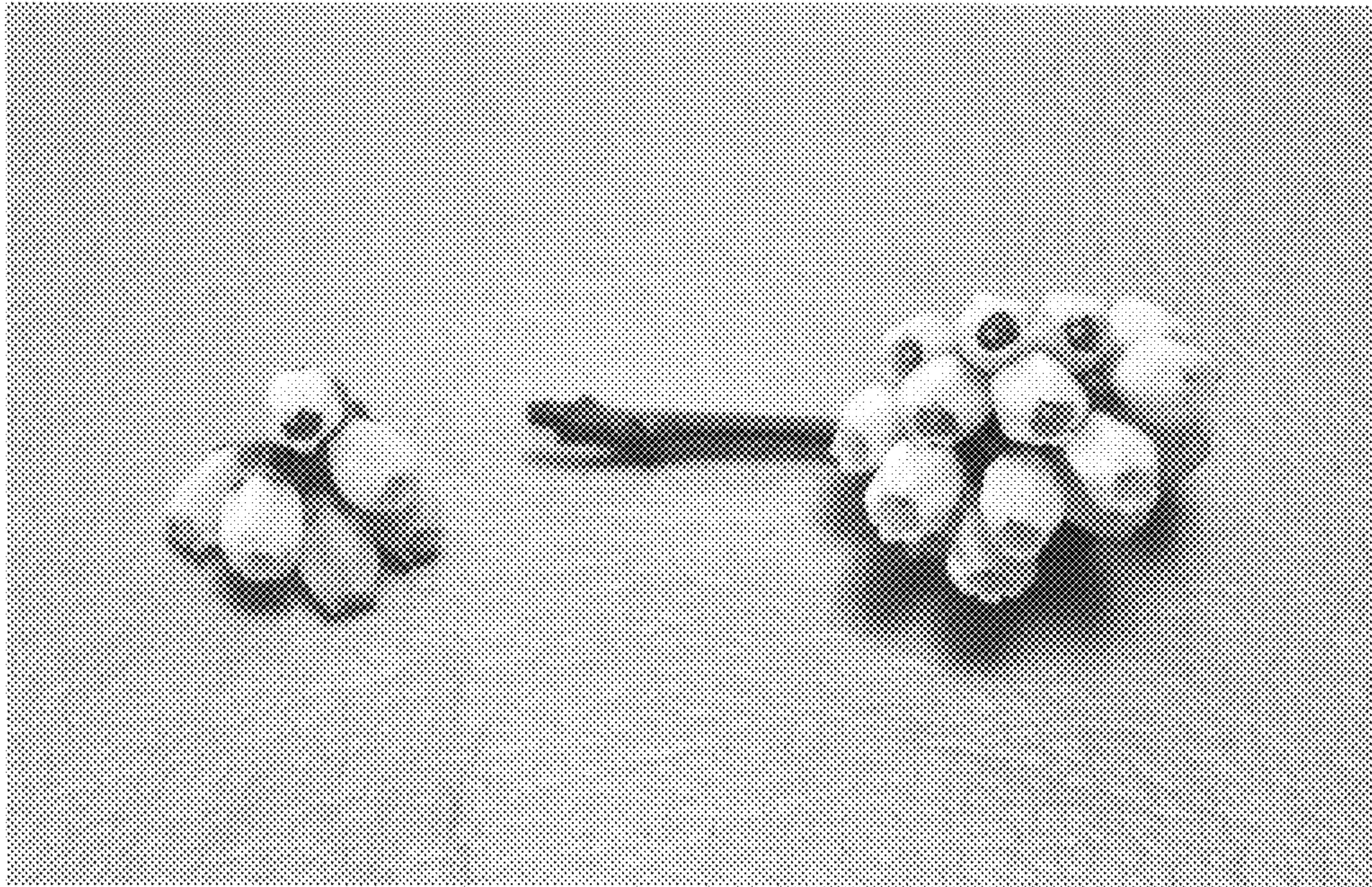


FIG. 1

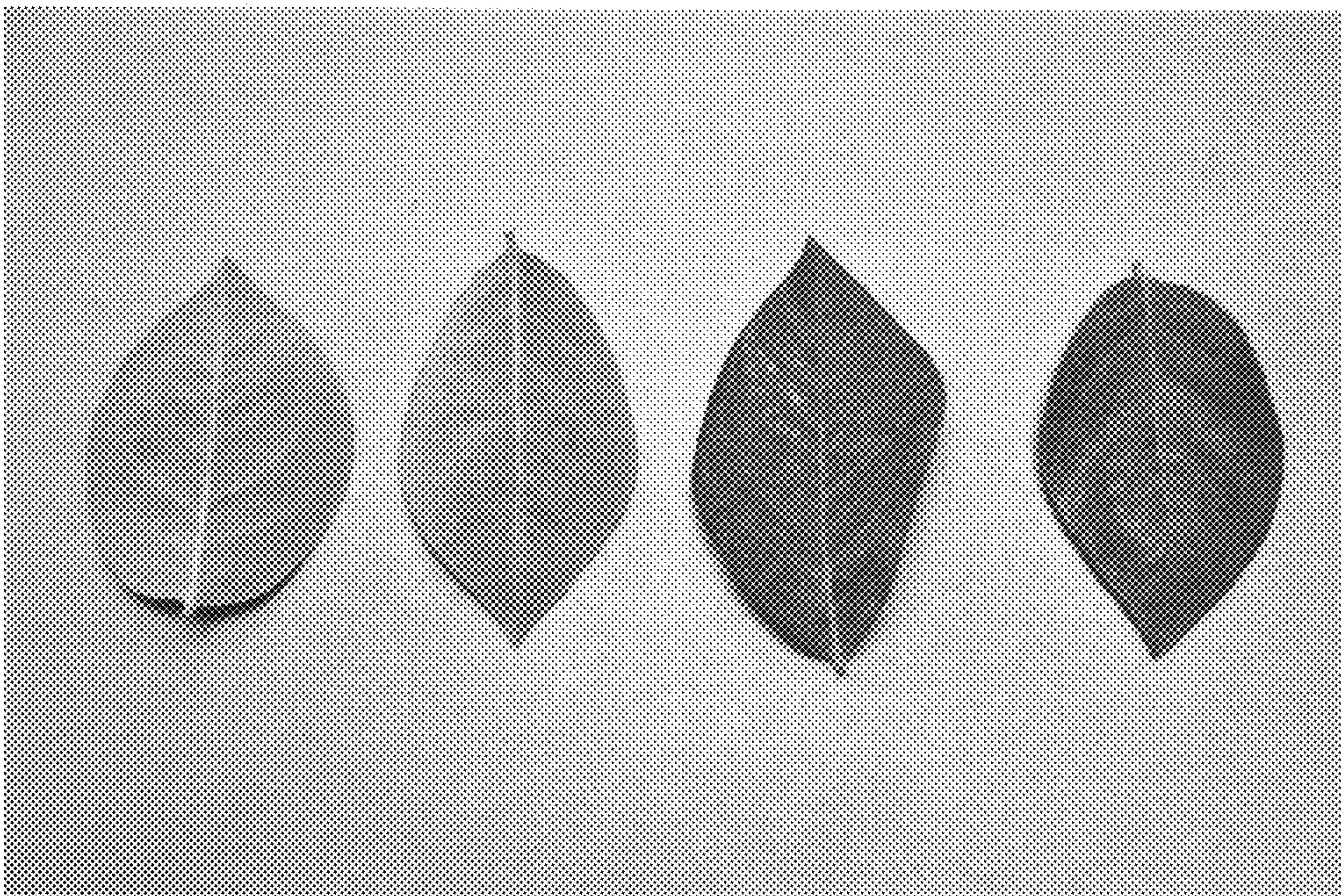


FIG. 2

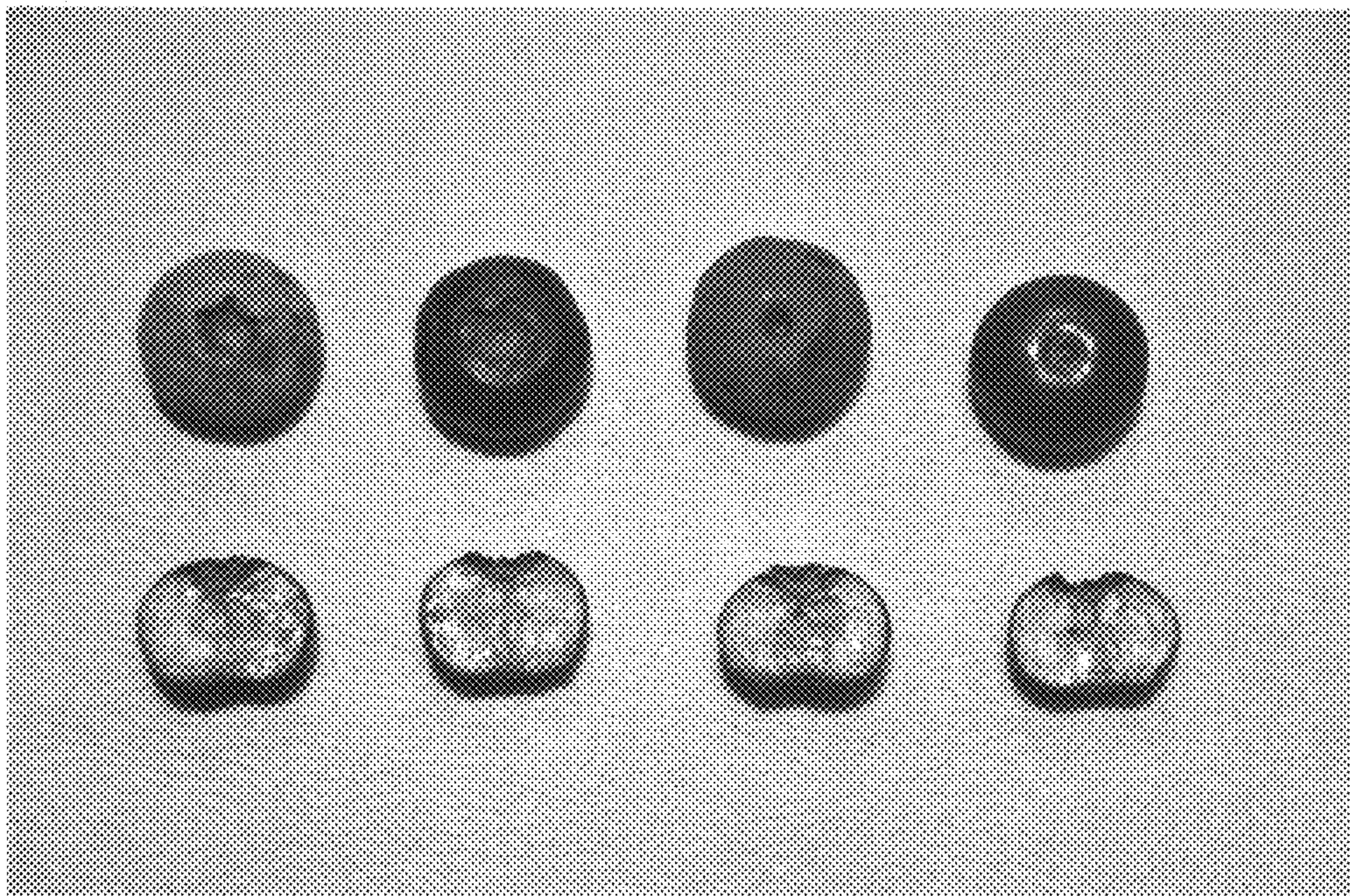


FIG. 3